

Everything and the kitchen sink

Or: Nine factors to determine if a postcode has what it needs to be 'liveable':

1. Employment access

You need to get to work each day as easily as possible. End of story.

2. Transport: train, tram, light rail, bus, ferry

Are public transport routes close to your chosen property? It's a simple indicator, even if there is room for governments and the private sector to do better.

3. House pride

Are locals adding value to their properties? Neighbours who keep tidy houses and gardens, and who update their properties before they fall into disrepair, help to boost appeal and prices for the whole street.

4. Culture

Look for libraries, galleries and live-music venues that make a suburb vibrant and encourage diversity.

5. Traffic congestion

Are this suburb's streets a thoroughfare for drivers avoiding toll roads or snarls on major highways? Be sure to attend 'open for inspections' at peak hours to get a measure on how busy the roads in your area will be at crucial times, which will affect your own commute, and peace and quiet.

6. Schools

This might not be a consideration for you, but for resale, a property in walking distance to a well-performing school will boost its market appeal.

7. Shops, cafés and restaurants